

FEED READERS

Taming The Internet

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News, media, business and tech companies need to be wired into the news and events in their line of business — in the online world, things happen fast. Whether you're an advertising agency trying to track the success of your viral media campaign, or a PR company trying to defend your client's online reputation, a scientist, tech journalist or a champion blogger — these tools below will definitely give you an edge. They will reduce time spent browsing and streamline all the information received.

Feed readers can find, manage and subscribe to RSS feeds. They keep a real-time track on keywords, help you share and manage the news, and save stories so they can be found again.

We will cover:**Browser-based RSS readers**

Google Reader
Bloglines.com

Feed readers for the Desktop

NewsGator
FeedDemon 2.7
FeedReader 3
Snarfer

Browser-based RSS Readers

Web Apps often look great and are fun to tinker around with, but when it comes to it, a dedicated application that runs natively from your PC offers you many benefits: you can make a backup, work offline, and get to have control of your data. Browser-based apps however have evolved considerably, and the social aspect of these apps is the most compelling reason why users keep coming back. We look at two browser-based feed readers for keeping you updated with the news — Google Reader and Bloglines.

Why go to the news when you can have the news come to you?



Reader now provides automatic translation for content that is in another language

Google Reader

URL: www.google.com/reader

Price: Free

This is a perfect RSS feed reader for both newbies and pros — Google Reader is an effective, easy to use RSS reader that lets you share your favourite blog entries or news stories with your friends. It's one of the best designed Web apps, designed to be keyboard friendly and social.

Log in to your Google Reader account the first time around and you might not feel so compelled, but once you have it configured to read a few feeds, and have other friends doing the same, it becomes an awesome new medium to recommend and discover good reads.

The UI interface is sleek and simple, with menu options that link to Home, All Items, Starred Items, Trends, Your Stuff, and Friends Shared Items. Viewing All Items will get you on the river-of-news mode, where you can surf through all your unread stories. An auto-sort option here can reorder this list so that feeds with fewer updates get a preference over feeds that update fre-

quently. It's a useful preference that lets you prioritise blog posts made by your friends over hundreds of news updates from CNN.com or boingboing.net.

Adding a news feed is easy — just paste the feed URL in the Add Subscription tab, and you're subscribed. If you like a particular entry, you can bookmark, share, email, and add notes to the entry. To save an article for future reference, click on the star at the bottom of the story. Clicking the Share button adds the item to a dynamically generated page. You can visit your shared items, have them posted on a publicly accessible page, or as a widget on your blog. You can also import your existing subscriptions into Google Reader. To do this, you first have to export your subscriptions in a standard format called OPML. Most RSS feed readers support this standard, Google allows you to export your subscriptions as an OPML file too.

Google has a Top Recommendations tab, that is auto-generated, based on the feeds that you have already subscribed to — these recommenda-